Going live: accounts, registrations and hosting

What ECCS needs before its app can be offered to real restaurants: organisation accounts on Google Play and the App Store, the D-U-N-S number behind both, SMS and WhatsApp for login codes, and a server to run it all. With requirements, steps, costs and how long each takes.

The short version

- **Almost everything here needs ECCS to be a registered business first.** The D-U-N-S number, both organisation accounts, SMS registration and WhatsApp verification all ask for business documents.
- **Start the slow items early:** the D-U-N-S number and SMS (DLT) registration each take days to weeks and other steps wait on them.
- **Running cost** is about ₹2,300 to ₹3,000 a month: the server, plus a small amount per login code.
- **One-time and yearly cost** is about ₹23,500 to ₹25,000 in the first year, most of it SMS registration and the Apple membership. Without the App Store it is about ₹15,000.

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Prepared for ECCS on 9 October 2026. Requirements were checked that day against the providers' own help pages where possible; those are marked Official. Facts taken from guides and vendor articles are marked Secondary and should be confirmed before money is spent. Prices in US dollars are converted at about ₹88 to the dollar and exclude 18% GST unless stated. Providers change their rules and prices; treat every figure as correct on the date above and check again at sign-up.

1. Everything at a glance

Item	What it needs	Cost	Time it takes
D-U-N-S number	A legal entity: its legal name, head-office and mailing address, a work contact	Free	Up to 5 working days from Dun & Bradstreet, then up to 2 more before Apple can see it. Guides report 2 to 4 weeks in India
Google Play organisation account	D-U-N-S number, organisation name and address matching it, a verified organisation website, contact and public developer email and phone	US$25 once (about ₹2,200)	Days for verification; payment check alone "can take up to 5 days"
Apple Developer Program (organisation)	Legal entity, D-U-N-S number, a working website on the organisation's own domain, a work email on that domain, a person with authority to sign	US$99 a year (about ₹8,700 to ₹9,500)	Days to a few weeks after the D-U-N-S number is visible to Apple
SMS login codes (DLT)	Registration as a "Principal Entity" with a telecom operator: PAN, GST certificate, proof of the business, signatory's ID; then a sender name and message templates	About ₹5,900 once, plus about ₹5,900 per sender name; then ₹0.13 to ₹0.25 per SMS	2 to 5 working days for the entity; more for the sender name and templates
WhatsApp login codes	A Meta Business account, business verification with a government document, a phone number for WhatsApp, an approved "authentication" template	About ₹0.115 per code, plus any provider fee	1 to 3 days for verification, per guides
Hosting	One server in India with 4 GB of memory, a domain name, storage for photos and backups	About ₹2,200 to ₹2,700 a month for the server; domain ₹800 to ₹1,500 a year	A day or two to set up once the accounts exist

Where ECCS stands today

ECCS is not yet a registered company. A personal Google Play developer account is being opened so that testing can begin, with the plan to convert it to an organisation account later. Sections 2 to 5 describe what that conversion, and the App Store, will need.

2. First: a registered business

Each item in this document asks, in its own words, for proof that ECCS exists as a business. That makes registration the first step, ahead of everything else.

Who asks	What they ask for	Source
Apple (organisation account)	"Your organization must be a legal entity that can enter into contracts with Apple. We do not accept DBAs, fictitious business names, trade names, or branches."	Official
Dun & Bradstreet (D-U-N-S), as described by Apple	"Your business must be recognized as a legal entity (such as a corporation, limited partnership, or limited liability company)."	Official
Google Play (organisation account)	A D-U-N-S number, with the organisation's name and address matching the Dun & Bradstreet record.	Official
Telecom operators (DLT)	PAN, GST certificate, certificate of incorporation, address proof and the signatory's ID. For a proprietorship: PAN, GST and the proprietor's Aadhaar.	Secondary
Meta (WhatsApp)	A registered legal entity, shown by a government document such as a GST certificate, certificate of incorporation or Udyam (MSME) registration.	Secondary

What kind of registration is enough?

Sole proprietorship (with GST and Udyam)

The quickest and cheapest to set up.

- Guides say it is accepted for DLT and for Meta verification.
- **Apple treats it as an individual:** a sole proprietor enrols as an individual, needs no D-U-N-S number, and the owner's personal legal name is shown as the seller.
- Whether Google will accept it for an organisation account depends on getting a D-U-N-S number in the business's name; not confirmed.

A company or LLP

More paperwork and yearly filings, but it meets every requirement here.

- Qualifies for a D-U-N-S number as a legal entity.
- Lets both stores show "ECCS" (the organisation's name) as the publisher, not a person's name.
- Needed for Apple's organisation enrolment.

To decide with a chartered accountant

Which form of business to register. If the App Store and an organisation name on both stores matter, that points to a company or LLP. This document does not advise on tax or company law.

3. The D-U-N-S number

A D-U-N-S number is a nine-digit number that identifies one business at one location. It is issued by Dun & Bradstreet (D&B) and used by both Apple and Google to confirm that an organisation is real. Official

What to have ready

- The legal entity's name, exactly as registered
- The head-office address and the mailing address
- Your work contact details

Steps

1. **Check whether one already exists.** Use Apple's look-up tool at developer.apple.com/enroll/duns-lookup. D&B "may have already assigned your organization a free D-U-N-S Number".
2. **If the business is not listed, request one from the same tool.** It offers to send your details to D&B for a free number.
3. **Answer D&B if they contact you.** They may phone or email to confirm the business's details.
4. **Wait.** "Please allow up to 5 business days to receive your number from D&B", then "up to 2 business days for Apple to receive your information from D&B".
5. **Keep the details identical everywhere.** Google requires the organisation name and address in its payments profile to match the D&B record.

Point	Detail	Source
Cost	Free through Apple's tool. D&B also sells faster paid services; they are not required.	Official
Time	Apple states up to 5 working days plus 2. Guides for India report 2 to 4 weeks in practice.	Official Secondary
Who cannot get one for Apple's purposes	"DBAs, fictitious businesses, trade names, and branches are not accepted."	Official
One number, two stores	The same D-U-N-S number is used for both Google Play and the App Store.	Official

4. Google Play organisation account

ECCS is starting with a personal account. This section is what the organisation account needs, and how the personal account is converted.

Requirements Official

Needed	Detail
D-U-N-S number	Described by Google as "a unique nine-digit identifier that is widely used to verify businesses".
Organisation name and address	Taken from the linked Google payments profile, and must match the Dun & Bradstreet record.
Organisation website	Must be provided and verified before the account type can be changed.
Organisation phone number	Used for verification.
Contact name, email and phone	For Google to reach you. Not public. Email and phone are verified by a one-time code.
Developer email and phone	Shown publicly on Google Play.
Registration fee	US$25, paid once. Visa, MasterCard and American Express are accepted; prepaid cards are not.

What becomes public

For an organisation: "Google will display your legal name, legal address, developer email address, and developer phone number on Google Play." For a personal account it is the person's legal name, country and developer email.

Converting the personal account to an organisation account Official

1. **Get the D-U-N-S number** (section 3).
2. **Create a new organisational payments profile** in Google, entering the D-U-N-S number. The name and address must match the D&B record.
3. **Add the organisation's official website** in the Play Console, save it, and click "Send verification request".
4. **Wait for the website to be verified.** Only then does the option to change the account type appear.
5. **Change the account type** and link the new payments profile.

Good to know	Detail	Source
One-way only	Google does not support changing an organisation account back to a personal one.	Official
The other route	Open a separate organisation account and transfer the app to it. Users, download statistics, ratings, reviews and the store listing move with the app.	Official

Good to know	Detail	Source
The 12-tester rule	Personal accounts created after 13 November 2023 must run a closed test with at least 12 testers opted in continuously for 14 days before applying to publish. Internal testing (up to 100 testers, available within minutes) does not count towards it.	Official
Not confirmed	Whether an account that began as personal is released from the 12-tester rule once converted. Google's pages do not say.	Unknown

5. Apple Developer Program (for the App Store)

Publishing on the App Store needs a paid yearly membership. The app has so far been built and tested for Android only; an iPhone version needs its own build and testing, which is separate work from the account.

Organisation enrolment: requirements Official

Needed	Detail
Apple Account	With two-factor authentication on, using the enrolling person's legal first and last name. Apple recommends an email address from the organisation.
Legal entity	"Your organization must be a legal entity that can enter into contracts with Apple." Trade names and branches are not accepted. The organisation's name is shown as the seller on the App Store.
D-U-N-S number	Used "to verify your organization's identity, legal entity status, and address".
Authority to sign	The person enrolling becomes the Account Holder and "must have the legal authority to bind your organization to legal agreements": the owner or founder, an executive, a senior project lead, or an employee given that authority.
Work email	"Your work email address needs to [be] associated with your organization's domain name."
Website	"Publicly available and functional", on a domain belonging to the organisation. Social media pages and placeholder pages are not accepted.
Fee	"99 USD per membership year. Prices may vary by region and are listed in local currency during the enrollment process."

Steps

1. **Create the Apple Account** with the organisation's email address and switch on two-factor authentication.
2. **Confirm the D-U-N-S number is visible to Apple** using the look-up tool (allow 2 working days after D&B issues it).

3. **Start enrolment** at developer.apple.com/programs/enroll, or in the Apple Developer app on an iPhone, iPad or Mac, and choose "Company / Organization".
4. **Enter the organisation's details:** legal name, D-U-N-S number, website, your role and authority.
5. **Answer Apple's verification.** Apple may phone or email the person enrolling to confirm their authority.
6. **Agree to the licence and pay** the yearly fee once Apple approves the details.

If ECCS is a sole proprietorship

Enrol as an **individual**. No D-U-N-S number is needed, the fee is the same, and Apple verifies the person's legal name, email, phone and address (no P.O. boxes). The person's own name is shown as the seller. Official Secondary

The fee in rupees

Apple shows the price in rupees at enrolment. Guides put it between about ₹8,700 and ₹9,500 a year, depending on the exchange rate. It renews every year; if it lapses, the app is removed from sale. Secondary

6. Login codes by SMS (DLT registration)

The app logs in restaurant owners and ECCS staff with a one-time code sent to their phone. In India, a business cannot send SMS to customers until it is registered on the telecom operators' DLT system (Distributed Ledger Technology), under TRAI's commercial-communication regulation. Today the app uses a fixed test code and sends no SMS.

The three things that get registered Secondary

What	What it is	Cost and time
Principal Entity	ECCS itself, as a sender of business SMS. Registered once on any one operator's portal (Jio, Airtel, Vodafone Idea or BSNL); the Entity ID then carries across all of them.	About ₹5,900 once (₹5,000 plus GST). 2 to 5 working days.
Header (sender name)	The six-letter name the SMS arrives from, for example a short form of ECCS.	About ₹5,900 each. Approval takes further days.
Content template	The exact wording of each message, with the variable part marked, for example "Your ECCS login code is {code}".	Usually no fee. Each template is approved separately.

Documents Secondary

- **A company:** PAN card, GST certificate, certificate of incorporation, address proof, the authorised signatory's ID and a letter of authorisation.
- **A proprietorship:** PAN, GST certificate and the proprietor's Aadhaar.

Steps

1. **Choose an SMS provider** (for example MSG91, 2Factor or Message Central). They guide the registration and send the messages afterwards.
2. **Register ECCS as a Principal Entity** on one operator's DLT portal, upload the documents and pay the fee.
3. **Register the sender name** once the entity is approved.
4. **Register the login-code template** and wait for approval.
5. **Give the provider the Entity ID, sender name and template ID.** The app is then connected to the provider and the fixed test code is switched off.

Running cost	Detail
Per login code	About ₹0.13 to ₹0.25 per SMS, plus GST, depending on provider and volume. Secondary
At pilot scale	1,000 codes a month would cost roughly ₹130 to ₹250.

7. Login codes by WhatsApp (an alternative or an addition)

The login code can be sent as a WhatsApp message instead of, or as well as, an SMS. It goes through the WhatsApp Business Platform, Meta's service for businesses, which is different from the ordinary WhatsApp Business phone app.

Requirements

Needed	Detail	Source
Meta Business account	Created at business.facebook.com in ECCS's name.	Secondary
Business verification	Meta checks the business name, address and phone against a government document: a GST certificate (reported as the quickest), a certificate of incorporation, or Udyam registration. Reported to take 1 to 3 days.	Secondary
A phone number	A number for ECCS's WhatsApp sender that is not already in use on WhatsApp, verified by a code.	Secondary
An approved template	Login codes must use Meta's "authentication" template format, submitted and approved before use.	Secondary
Optionally, a provider	Meta can be used directly (the "Cloud API"), or through a provider that adds a dashboard and support for a fee.	Secondary

What it costs

Type of message	Charge in India	Source
Authentication (login codes)	About ₹0.115 per message, plus GST	Secondary
Utility (reminders, receipts)	About ₹0.115 per message; free when sent inside an open customer-service window	Official Secondary
Marketing	About ₹0.86 per message	Secondary
How Meta charges	Per delivered template message, since 1 July 2025. The current rate card is published at business.whatsapp.com/products/platform-pricing.	Official

SMS or WhatsApp?

	SMS	WhatsApp
Reaches	Every phone, including basic ones	Only phones with WhatsApp installed
Set-up	DLT registration: about ₹11,800 and one to two weeks	Meta verification: no fee, a few days
Per code	₹0.13 to ₹0.25	About ₹0.115
Also useful for	Nothing else in the app today	Reminders and reports to owners, a channel the research for ECCS recommended

> **A reasonable approach**
> Start with WhatsApp, because it is quicker and cheaper to set up and restaurant owners already use it, and add SMS as the fallback for anyone who does not receive the WhatsApp code. Both need a registered business.

8. Hosting and servers

Today the app runs on one PC in the office and works only on the office Wi-Fi. To be used anywhere it must run on a rented server with a secure web address.

What has to be hosted

Part	What it does	What it needs
The application server	Everything the app and the office console ask for; also makes the PDF reports, invoices and certificates	Memory: making PDFs needs a browser on the server, so 4 GB is advised

Part	What it does	What it needs
The database	Clients, visits, checklists, invoices, staff records	Daily backups kept somewhere other than the server
File storage	Proof photos, licence documents, PDFs	Grows over time; cheap storage that is separate from the server
The office console and public page	The website ECCS staff use, and the page a diner reaches from a QR code	A domain name and a security certificate (https)

The options

	Option 1: one server	Option 2: server plus managed database	Option 3: a managed platform
What it is	One rented machine running everything, as the office PC does now	The same, but the provider runs and backs up the database	The provider runs each part; no server to look after
Examples	DigitalOcean (Bangalore), AWS Lightsail (Mumbai)	The same providers' database service	Render, Railway, Fly.io
Per month	US$24 for 4 GB, plus about US$5 for backups	US$24 plus US$15 to US$30	About US$30 to US$60 for this app
In rupees	₹2,200 to ₹2,700	₹3,500 to ₹5,000	₹2,700 to ₹5,300
In India	Yes	Yes	Varies; Render's nearest is Singapore
Main risk	One machine holds everything, so backups are essential	Costs more	Published prices are for very small apps; this one needs more memory

Server prices are from price listings dated September 2026. Secondary

Recommended: option 1, in India

- It keeps the app fast on kitchen phones and keeps customer data in the country.
- It matches how the app already runs, so moving is a copy and not a redesign.
- It is enough for a pilot of a few dozen restaurants, and the database can move to option 2 later.

What else is needed around the server

Item	Detail	Cost
Domain name	The app's web address. Also needed for the organisation website and work email that Apple and Google ask for. Once QR codes are printed, the address cannot change without reprinting them.	₹800 to ₹1,500 a year
Security certificate	Required by Android, the Play Store and the App Store.	Free
Photo and backup storage	For example Cloudflare R2: the first 10 GB free, then about US$0.015 per GB a month.	Free at first
Push notifications	Already set up through Expo and Firebase.	Free
Payments	The app's payments are samples. Real payments need a provider such as Razorpay, which also asks for business documents and charges per transaction (about 2% plus GST).	Per transaction

9. Costs together, and the order to do things

One-time and yearly

Item	Amount	How often
Google Play developer account	about ₹2,200 (US$25)	Once
Apple Developer Program	about ₹8,700 to ₹9,500	Every year
D-U-N-S number	Free	Once
DLT: entity registration	about ₹5,900	Once
DLT: one sender name	about ₹5,900	Once
WhatsApp: Meta verification	Free	Once
Domain name	₹800 to ₹1,500	Every year
First-year total	**about ₹23,500 to ₹25,000**	

Excludes the cost of registering the business itself, professional fees, and GST on the items priced in dollars. Without the App Store, the first-year total is about ₹14,800 to ₹15,500.

Every month

Item	Amount
Server with backups (option 1)	₹2,200 to ₹2,700
Photo and backup storage	Free up to 10 GB
Login codes, at 1,000 a month	about ₹115 to ₹250
Monthly total	**about ₹2,300 to ₹3,000**

The order to do things

1. **Now, with no registration needed:** the personal Google Play account (under way), a domain name, and the hosting. With these, the app can reach up to 100 invited testers through Google Play's internal testing.
2. **Register the business.** Decide the form with a chartered accountant; obtain PAN, GST and, for a company, the certificate of incorporation.
3. **Put up the organisation's website and work email** on the domain. Apple and Google both check them.
4. **Request the D-U-N-S number.** Allow two to four weeks.
5. **Start WhatsApp verification and DLT registration** in parallel with the D-U-N-S wait; neither depends on it.
6. **Convert the Google Play account to an organisation account** once the D-U-N-S number and website are verified.
7. **Enrol in the Apple Developer Program** when an iPhone version is wanted.
8. **Before the public launch:** a privacy policy, the stores' data-safety forms, a way for users to ask for their account to be deleted, real prices and company details in the app, and a real payment provider.

10. Sources and what was not confirmed

Not confirmed

- Whether Dun & Bradstreet will issue a D-U-N-S number to an Indian sole proprietorship, and whether Google accepts one for an organisation account.
- Whether a Google Play account converted from personal to organisation is released from the 12-tester requirement.
- The exact DLT fees and document lists, which differ slightly between operators and are taken from providers' guides, not from the operators' own portals.
- WhatsApp's per-message rates in rupees, which are from providers' summaries of Meta's rate card and change from time to time.
- Server prices in the India regions specifically; listings give one price for all regions.
- How long each verification takes in practice. Only the times quoted from Apple and Google are the providers' own.

Official pages (read on 9 October 2026)

- Google Play Console Help: Required information to create a developer account. support.google.com/googleplay/android-developer/answer/139626
- Google Play Console Help: Verifying your developer identity information. support.google.com/googleplay/android-developer/answer/13628312
- Google Play Console Help: Choose a developer account type. support.google.com/googleplay/android-developer/answer/13634885
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